USER GUIDE

How to use Batches

How the Ladles of Love warehouse system works, what it does for the team, and every job step by step, from the gate to the report.

For warehouse staff, managers, admins and volunteers

SYSTEM	ORGANISATION	VERSION
Batches warehouse system	Ladles of Love, Cape Town	October 2026

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WHO SHOULD READ WHAT

Everyone reads sections 1 to 4. **Warehouse staff** then read section 5. **Managers** read sections 5 and 6, because they supervise the floor. **Admins** read section 7, and section 6 for the screens they share with managers. Section 8 is a weekly checklist for the whole team. The people who host and maintain the system have a separate document: *Batches handover*.

01

EVERYONE

Start here

Batches is the Ladles of Love warehouse system. It records food coming in, packs it for the centres we feed, sends it out, and turns all of that into numbers the organisation can act on and report to funders.

Everyone signs in at the same web address and sees only the screens for their job. Warehouse staff use it on a phone or tablet on the floor; managers and admins use it on a laptop or desktop browser. Volunteers can help without an account at all. It works in English, Afrikaans and isiXhosa on the floor, and it keeps working when the signal drops.

You are	You use Batches to	Device	Go to
Warehouse staff	Receive deliveries, pack pallets, decant bulk food, hand pallets to drivers, record donations, log benevolent requests and Feed the Soil compost	Phone or tablet	Section 5
Manager	Order from suppliers, make picking slips, look after centres, watch stock, approve requests, run programmes and reports	Laptop or desktop	Sections 5 and 6
Admin	Add people, products and suppliers, lay out the warehouse, change settings, check the logs	Laptop or desktop	Section 7
Volunteer (guest)	Pack one pallet, with no account	Phone	Section 4.2

HOW TO READ THIS GUIDE

- Each picture has **red numbered boxes**. The numbered steps next to or under the picture match them.
- The names and numbers in the pictures are examples, not real records.
- Tip boxes are shortcuts; Watch out boxes are the mistakes people make most.
- Words in **bold** are the names of buttons, tabs and menus exactly as they appear on screen.

HELP IS BUILT IN

You never need this guide open to use Batches. Every role has **Help** in the name menu (top right) with short steps for the screen you are on, and the round chat button at the bottom right answers questions in your own words, such as "how do I fix a wrong count?".

02

EVERYONE

What Batches changes

Before Batches, the warehouse ran on Salesforce, Excel, a Google stock sheet, paper picking slips and a paper register. Every number was typed at least twice, stock was only known after the Friday count, and there was no simple way to see which centres had not collected.

Batches replaces those separate tools with one system that every person on the team works in. Each action is recorded once, at the moment it happens, by the person doing it, and every other screen and report reads from that same record.

JOB	BEFORE	WITH BATCHES
Picking slips	Printed from Salesforce and Excel, quantities worked out by hand for each new centre	Generated for a whole cohort in one click from the recipe and each centre's child count, with a QR code per pallet. Paper is optional.
Stock	A physical sheet, a Google sheet and QuickBooks, reconciled weekly	One live balance per product, changed only by recorded events (delivery, decant, dispatch, adjustment), with a ledger line for each
Receiving	Count, cross-check the note and invoice, walk the paper to Finance	Count against the approved order on a phone; the driver signs on screen; stock is added and the manager is told about any shortfall at once
Decanting	A decanting sheet and guesswork about how many bags of each size	Weigh the sack; Batches recommends how many 500 g, 1 kg and 2 kg bags to make for this week's slips, and records spillage
Dispatch	Quantities rechecked at the car, picking slip and register signed on paper	Check each line, take the driver's name and signature on screen, print or download a dispatch note. Stock comes off here.
Centres that do not collect	Hard to flag in Salesforce	Late and not-collected pallets are listed automatically; centres get a reminder before their pickup day
Donations	Sorted and recorded by hand; Section 18A handled separately	Recorded at the gate; unknown items go to a classification queue; donors who want Section 18A get a secure form and a certificate
Finance	Orders captured again in QuickBooks	An approved purchase order is emailed to Finance, or sent straight to QuickBooks when it is connected
Reports	Dashboards hard to retrieve	Live dashboard, a report builder, questions in plain words, scheduled report emails, an impact report for funders and a map of centres reached

What each part of the team gains

WAREHOUSE FLOOR

Less paper, fewer recounts

One job at a time on a phone, in their own language, that keeps working with no signal. Short or damaged items are flagged with a photo instead of a note on a slip.

MANAGERS

See today, not last Friday

A dashboard of what needs attention now: orders to approve, shortfalls, near-expiry stock, pallets not collected. Every number links to the records behind it.

ORGANISATION

Proof of impact

Meals enabled, kilograms dispatched, centres reached and volunteer hours come straight from operations, ready for funders, Section 18A and the board.

FINANCE

One capture

Approved orders reach Finance or QuickBooks without retyping; delivery and dispatch notes are filed and searchable under Receipts.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Who did what, when

Every change is recorded with a name and time. People and products are deactivated, never deleted, so history stays intact.

GROWTH

Ready for more sites

Gauteng and Northern Cape can each run their own warehouse in the same app, with their own data, and staff who work at two sites switch between them.

The ideas behind the design

Record rather than block

Food cannot wait for a system. A short delivery, a late collection or a pallet on the wrong day is recorded and flagged for a manager, not refused. Batches only stops you where going ahead would be wrong, such as releasing a pallet to a centre that is no longer active.

Record it once, where it happens

The person at the gate records the delivery; nobody types it again. Stock, orders, reports and Finance all read that one record.

Built for the floor

Large buttons, one step at a time, three languages, photos, and an outbox that holds work until the signal returns.

Everyone sees only their job

Each role has its own screens and menu. The server checks the role on every action, not just the menu.

03

EVERYONE

How Batches works

Understanding the path food takes through the system makes every screen easier: each screen is one step on that path, and each step hands over to the next.

The path food takes

Order — Manager raises a purchase order — MANAGER

›

Approve — Finance is emailed; it appears on the floor — MANAGER

›

Receive — Counted at the gate; stock goes up — FLOOR

›

Decant — Bulk sacks become bags — FLOOR

›

Slip — Each centre's pallet is worked out — MANAGER

›

Pack — Pallet packed and flagged — FLOOR OR VOLUNTEER

›

Dispatch — Driver signs; stock goes down — FLOOR

›

Report — Dashboards, impact, Finance — MANAGER

Donations join the same path at **Receive**: they are recorded at the gate and become stock like a delivery. Benevolent requests and Feed the Soil run beside it with their own screens (sections 5.6 and 5.7).

How stock is counted

On hand

What is physically on the shelf right now

Committed

Packed onto a pallet or promised to a slip, but still in the building

Available

On hand minus committed: what is left to promise

Event	What happens to stock
Delivery received	On hand goes up by what was counted, not what was ordered
Donation recorded	On hand goes up for every item matched to a product; unknown items wait for a manager to classify
Decanting saved	The bulk product goes down; the bagged product goes up; spillage is recorded as wastage
Pallet packed	Nothing leaves yet. The packed amount counts as committed
Pallet dispatched	On hand goes down. This is the moment stock leaves the books
Stock adjusted	On hand changes to the counted figure, with a reason and your name in the stock ledger

> **WHOLE NUMBERS AND PART QUANTITIES**
>
> Things that are counted, like cans and packets, are always whole numbers. Only products marked *decantable*, like rice, oats or oil, can be part quantities such as 12.5 kg. The screens will ask for a whole number where one is needed.

Who can do what

Your role decides which screens you see and which actions the server will accept. If a colleague can see a screen you cannot, your role is different, not broken: ask an admin.

Area	Warehouse staff	Manager	Admin
Receiving, packing, decanting, dispatch, donation intake	Do	Supervise (sees the results)	—

Area	Warehouse staff	Manager	Admin
Purchase orders, picking slips, centres, stock	—	Do	—
Classification queue and Section 18A	—	Do	Do
Programmes and reports	Log on the floor	Do	Finance report
Users, products, suppliers, settings, layout, logs	—	—	Do

Notifications, reminders and alerts

- **The bell** (top right) lists what is new for you: a slip assigned to you, an order to approve, a product running low, stock close to expiry.
- **Phone alerts**: tap the bell on a floor phone to turn on alerts for new pallets, so a packer hears about work without opening the app.
- **Emails** go out from the organisation's Gmail account: invites, password resets, approved orders to Finance, thank-you emails and Section 18A forms to donors, collection reminders to centres, and scheduled reports. Every one is listed in Message history.
- **Red numbers** in the side menu and red dots on the floor's bottom bar show how many things wait inside.

Working with no signal

WHAT KEEPS WORKING

Screens open with the last copy they loaded. Deliveries, packed items and pallets, decanting sheets, donations, benevolent requests, compost weigh-ins and gate collections are saved on the phone and send themselves when the signal returns. A bar at the top lists what is waiting.

WHAT NEEDS A SIGNAL

Claiming or releasing a pallet, because two people must never pack the same one. Manager and admin screens also expect a connection.

WATCH OUT

Do not record the same thing again because it has not appeared yet. Batches recognises a resent save and only does it once, but a second, separate entry is a real second entry.

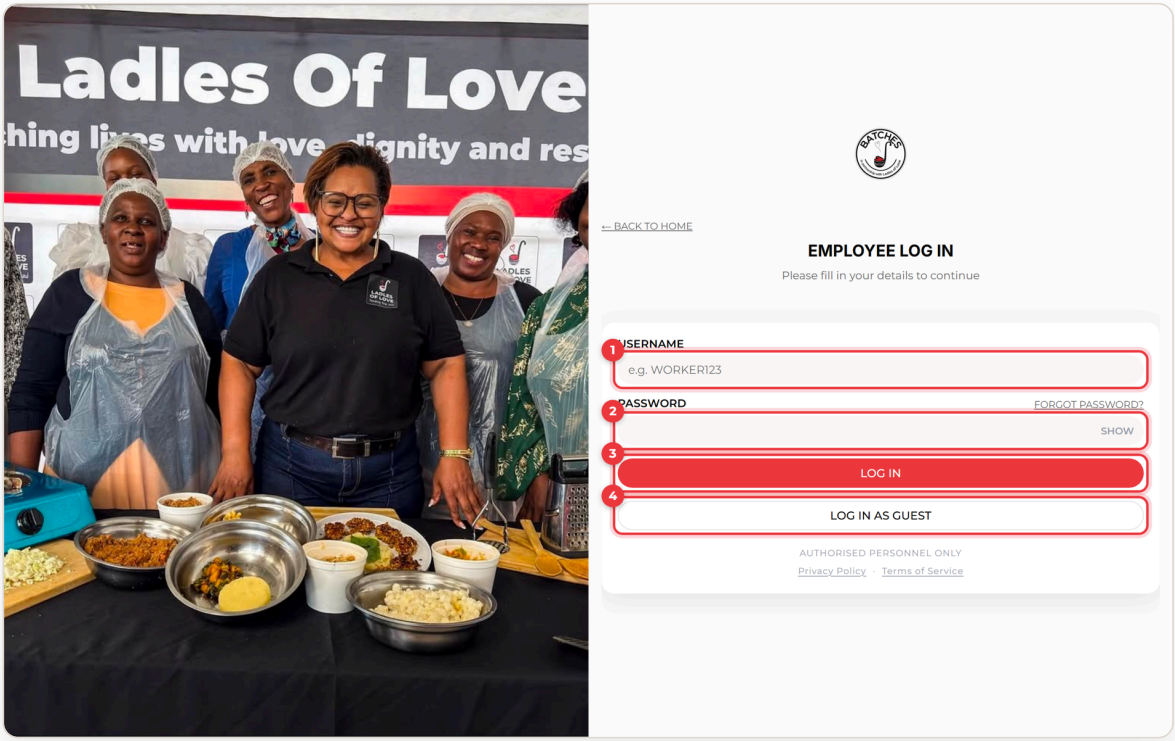
04

EVERYONE

Signing in and finding your way

One address for everyone. Staff sign in with a username and password; volunteers sign in as a guest with their name and the day's gate code.

4.1 Sign in



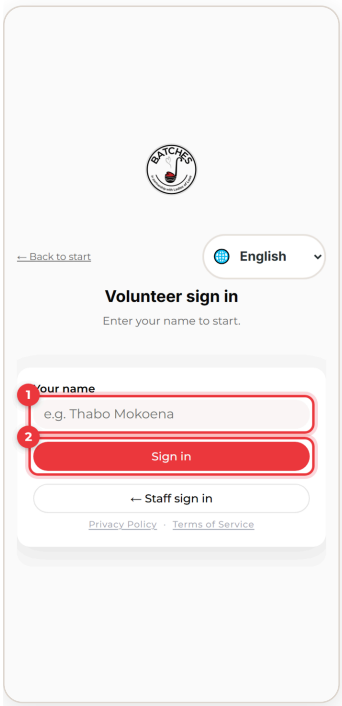
THE SIGN-IN PAGE

1. Type your **username**. Your admin gives it to you, or you chose it when you accepted your invite email.
2. Type your **password**. Tap **Show** to check what you typed. Forgot it? Tap **Forgot password?** and follow the email.
3. Tap **Log in**. You go straight to your own home screen.
4. **Log in as guest** is for volunteers without an account (see 4.2).

GOOD TO KNOW

- You stay signed in for 8 hours. On a shared tablet, sign out when you finish (name menu, then **Log out**).
- Your first account comes by email: an admin invites you, and the link lets you choose your username and password.
- Too many wrong passwords pauses sign-in for a while. Use **Forgot password?** rather than guessing; the reset link works once, for one hour.
- On a phone, use your browser's **Add to Home screen** to install Batches like an app.

4.2 Volunteers: sign in as a guest



VOLUNTEER SIGN IN

No account needed

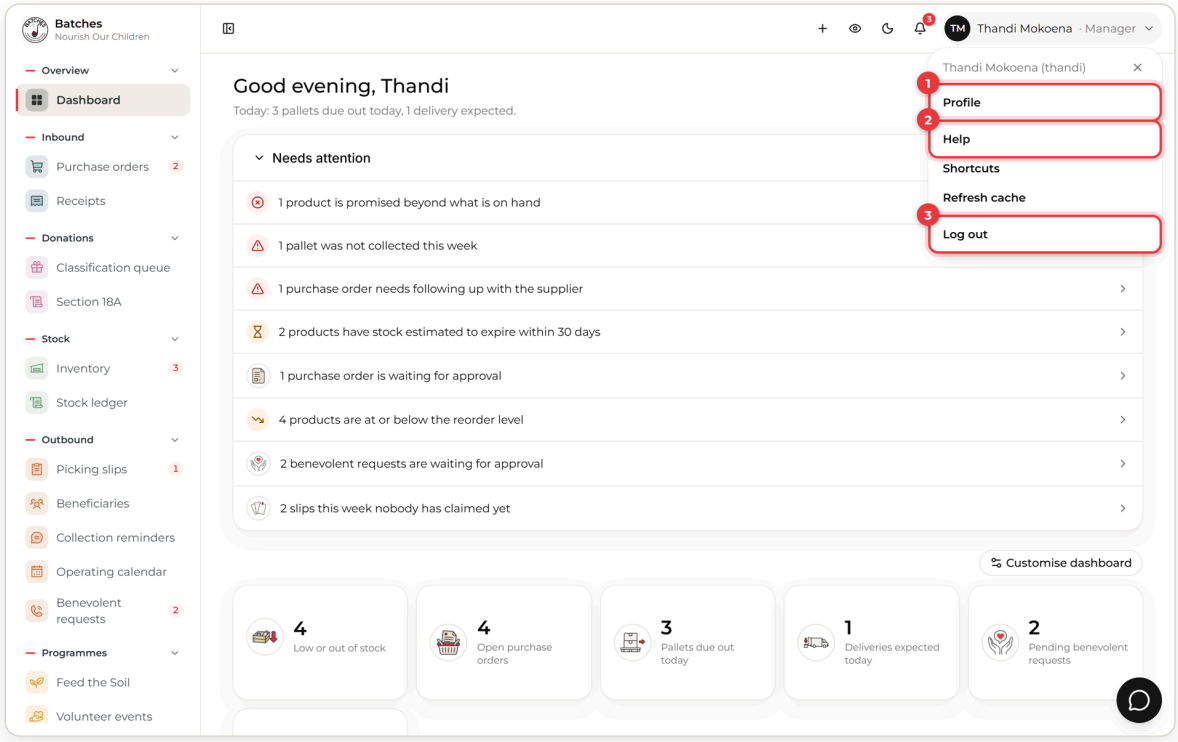
1. Type your **name**. It goes on the pallet you pack, so the warehouse knows who helped.
2. Tap **Sign in**. Then scan the QR code on a pallet, or type the short code a staff member gives you.

> **TIP**
>
> Pick your language at the top: English, Afrikaans or isiXhosa.

> **THE GATE CODE**
>
> Signing in without scanning a pallet asks for today's six-digit **gate code**, which proves the volunteer is at the warehouse. Managers and admins see it on their dashboard (the *Guest gate code* tile) and post it at the gate. It changes at midnight. Scanning a pallet's QR code does not need it.

A volunteer session lasts up to 12 hours and can only pack pallets: nothing else in the system is open to it. The volunteer's name is kept on the pallet record and in the volunteer sign-in log.

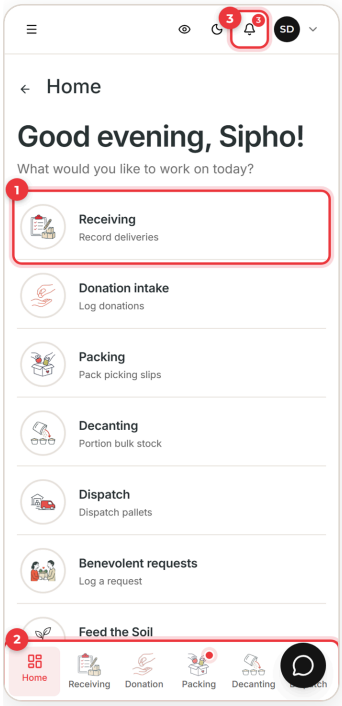
4.3 The parts every screen has



THE NAME MENU, TOP RIGHT

1. **Profile**: see your details, and change your email or password. You need your current password to do it.
2. **Help**: short answers about the screen you are on. The round chat button at the bottom right answers questions in your own words.
3. **Log out**.

- **The bell** shows new notifications, such as a new picking slip or a product running out. **See all notifications** opens the full list.
- **No signal?** Keep working. What you save waits on the phone and sends itself when the signal comes back. A bar at the top says what is waiting.
- **Guided or Form**: floor screens offer Guided (one thing at a time) or Form (everything on one page). Both do the same job. Pick the one you like; the screen remembers.
- **Dark mode and shortcuts**: the moon icon switches the colours; managers and admins can see keyboard shortcuts in the name menu.



YOUR HOME SCREEN

The floor's home screen

1. Tap a job to start it. Each one walks you through in a few steps.
2. The bottom bar is always there. A red dot means something new, for example a pallet waiting to be packed.
3. The bell shows your notifications.

> **TIP**
>
> Choose your language from your home screen. It follows you to any tablet you sign in on. The home screen, tab bar, no-signal bar and Packing are fully translated today; other floor screens are being translated.

05

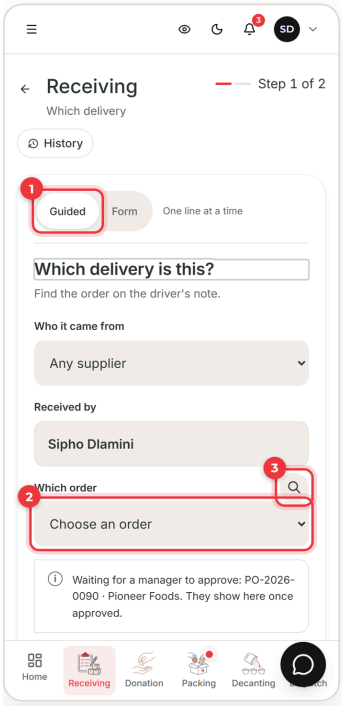
WAREHOUSE STAFF

On the warehouse floor

These screens are made for a phone or tablet. The bar along the bottom takes you between the jobs. Every job saves even with no signal, and every one has a History link to what was recorded before.

5.1 Receiving a delivery

Use this when a supplier's truck arrives against a purchase order. You count what actually arrived; Batches compares it with what was ordered.

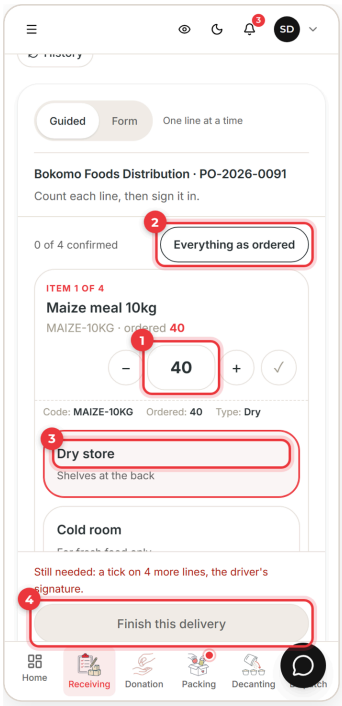


STEP 1: WHICH DELIVERY

Step 1: find the order

1. Choose **Guided** to count one line at a time, or **Form** to see every line at once.
2. Choose the order from the driver's note. Picking the supplier first makes the list shorter.
3. Or tap search and type the order number, supplier or date. Then tap **Start counting**.

> **TIP**
>
> Only approved orders appear. One still waiting for a manager is named under the list so you know why.



STEP 2: COUNT AND PUT AWAY

Step 2: count every line

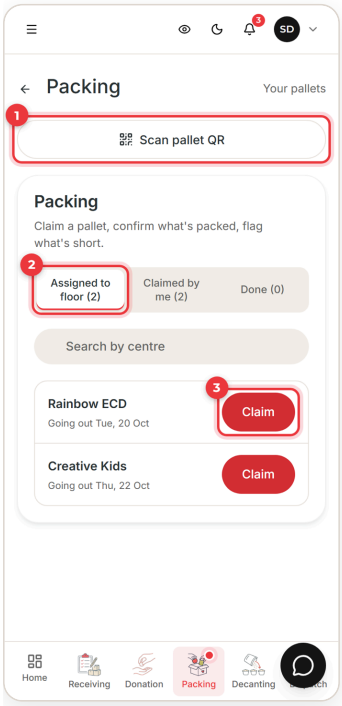
1. Type how many arrived, or use – and +. Tap the tick when the line is right.
2. If everything matches the order, **Everything as ordered** fills in every line for you.
3. Choose where it goes (**dry store** or **cold room**) and type the date on the box. Fresh food must have one.
4. Ask the driver to sign, then tap **Finish this delivery**. You can download the delivery note.

> **TIP**
>
> If a line is short, save it anyway. The order becomes *Partially received* and is flagged *Follow-up required*, so your manager follows it up with the supplier.

The stock is added the moment you finish. Use the camera button to add a photo of the delivery if something looks wrong; your manager sees it on the order.

5.2 Packing a pallet

Each pallet is one centre's food for its collection day, worked out by the manager on a picking slip. Pallets for the week appear on the floor as soon as the slips are made, whatever day they go out.

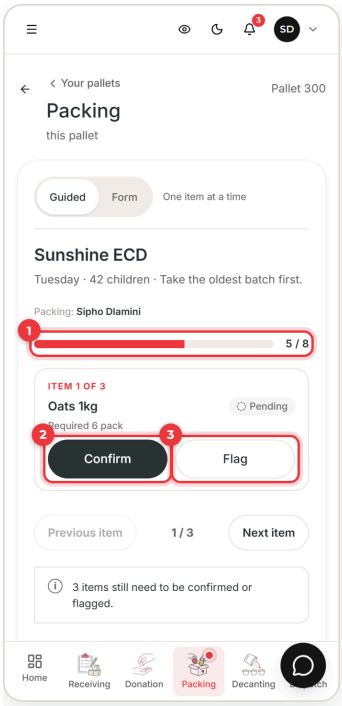


YOUR PALLETS

Claim a pallet

1. **Scan pallet QR** opens a pallet straight from its label.
2. **Assigned to floor** lists pallets nobody has taken yet. **Claimed by me** is your own list.
3. Tap **Claim** to take a pallet. It moves to your list and nobody else can pack it.

You can release a pallet again as long as you have not packed anything on it. Claiming and releasing need a signal.



PACKING ONE PALLET

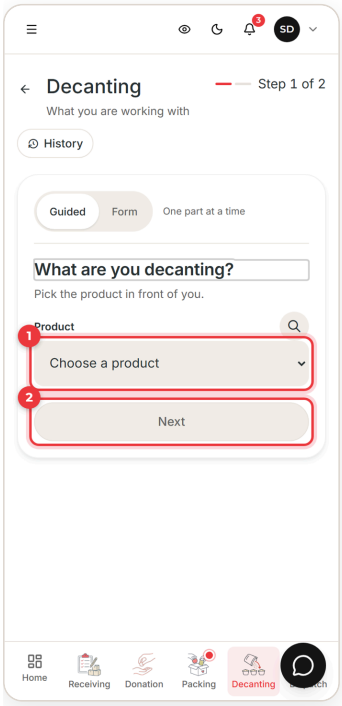
Pack each item

1. The bar shows how much of the pallet is done.
2. Packed the right amount? Tap **Confirm**.
3. Something short, damaged or missing? Tap **Flag**, choose why, and take a photo. The manager sees it on the slip.

> **TIP**
>
> Take the oldest stock first. When every item is confirmed or flagged, tap **Log pallet packed** and it shows at the gate.

5.3 Decanting bulk food

Bulk sacks of rice, oats, sugar or soya mince rarely weigh exactly 25 or 50 kg. Decanting records what you really got out of a sack, and tells you how many bags of each size this week's pallets need.



DECANTING

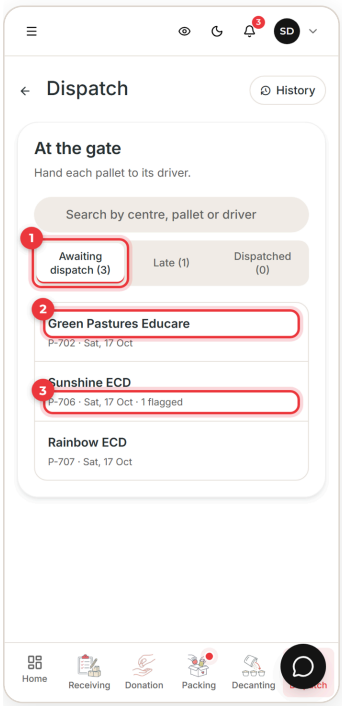
Weigh, bag and count back

1. Choose the product in front of you (for example a bulk sack of rice). Only products marked decantable are listed.
2. Tap **Next**. Weigh the bulk amount. Batches works out how many bags of each size to make.

- Use the recommended bag plan, or choose your own bag sizes (500 g, 1 kg, 2 kg, 5 kg or 10 kg).
- The weight cannot be more than is in stock. If the screen refuses it, weigh again or ask your manager to check the stock.

> **TIP**
>
> Count what you actually bagged and record anything spilled, then save. A saved sheet cannot be changed. It is kept under **History**.

5.4 Dispatch: handing pallets to drivers



AT THE GATE

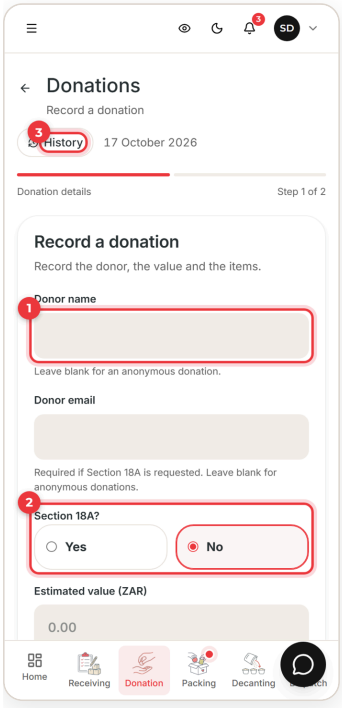
At the gate

1. **Awaiting dispatch** is today's pallets. **Late** is any not collected on their day.
2. Tap the centre whose driver is in front of you. Check the pallet, take the driver's name and signature, and confirm.
3. **1 flagged** means the packer flagged an item. Check it before it goes.

- Change a number only if what is loaded is different from what was packed.
- A pallet collected late or on another day still goes through. It is recorded for your manager.
- A pallet cannot be released to a centre that is no longer active. Call your manager.

> **TIP**
>
> Stock comes off the books here, when the pallet leaves, not when it is packed. The signed dispatch note replaces the paper register.

5.5 Recording a donation



RECORD A DONATION

Record the donor, then the items

1. The donor's name. Leave it blank for an anonymous donation.
2. **Section 18A?** Choose Yes if the donor wants a tax certificate. Their email is then needed.
3. **History** shows the donations you recorded and where each has got to.

- On the next step add each item and its estimated value. Search for the product, or mark it as an *unknown product* and describe it.
- Check the review screen, then submit. Matched items become stock at once; unknown items go to a manager in the **Classification queue**.
- A donor with an email gets a thank-you email. A Section 18A donor also gets a secure form to complete for their certificate.

5.6 Benevolent requests

For people or organisations who call in asking for food outside the centre programme.

1. Open **Benevolent requests** and log who called, what they asked for and when they will collect.
2. A manager approves it and chooses the items and quantities. Nothing is packed before that.
3. Claim an approved request, fetch the items, then confirm what went out.

5.7 Feed the Soil

1. **Assign a kit**: enter the owner's name and suburb. No address or phone number is kept.
2. **Log compost**: choose the kit, then enter the kilograms collected and the date.
3. Mark a record **dispatched** when the compost has gone to a farmer or drop-off point.

Kits that have not had a collection for a while are flagged to the manager automatically.

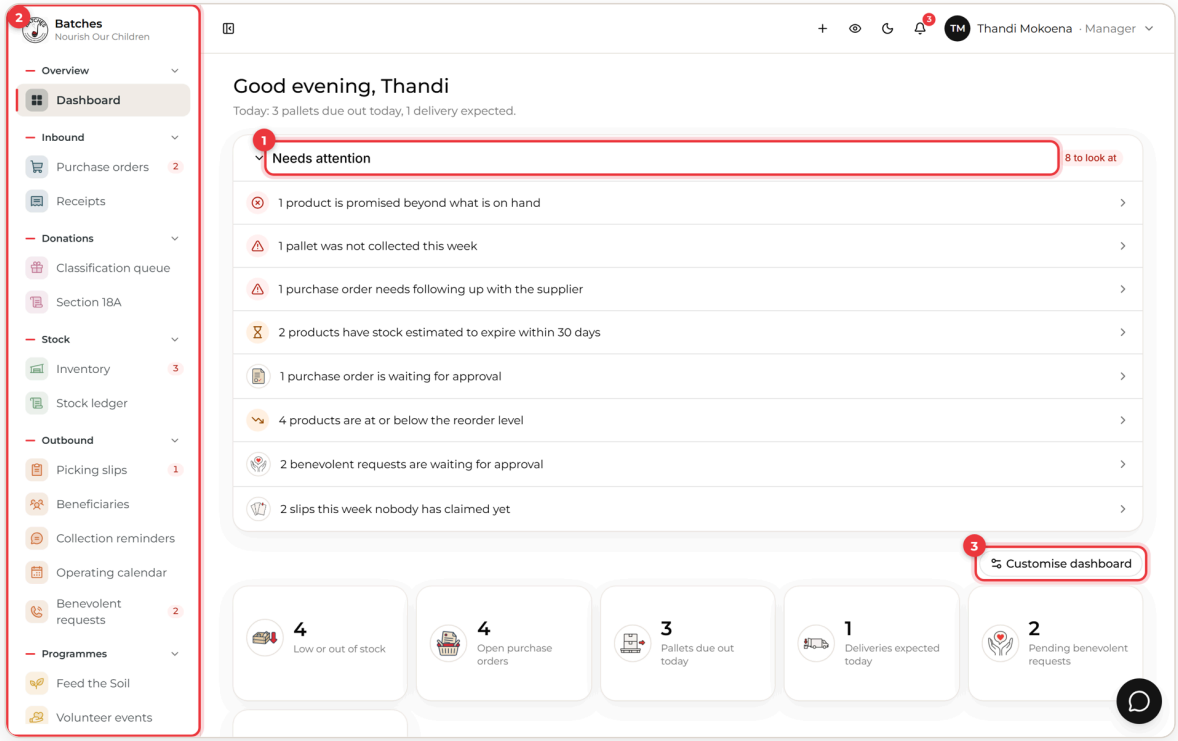
5.8 Photos, past records and alerts

- Use the camera button on a delivery or a flagged item to add a photo for your manager. The phone shrinks it before sending.
- Receiving, Decanting and Dispatch each have a **History** link to past records.
- Tap the bell to turn on alerts for new pallets on this phone.
- Your name and email are changed by an admin. Ask them if something is wrong.

06
Managers

Managers run the day-to-day: what is ordered, what each centre gets, what is in stock, and what needs following up. Everything starts from the dashboard.

6.1 Your dashboard

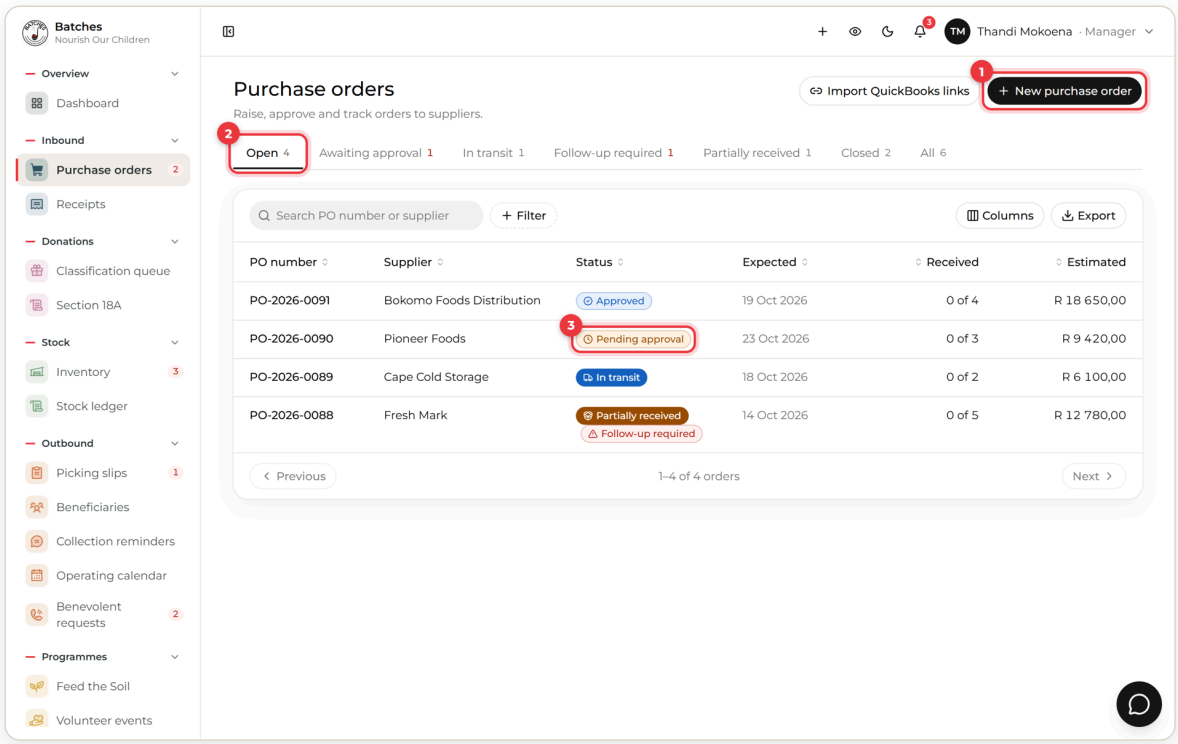


THE MANAGER DASHBOARD

1. **Needs attention** lists what needs you today: orders to approve, follow-ups, low and near-expiry stock, pallets not collected. Click a line to open exactly those records.
2. The side menu is grouped by job (Inbound, Stock, Outbound and so on). A red number shows how many things wait inside. Click a heading to fold it away.
3. **Customise dashboard** chooses which tiles and charts you see. The layout is saved to your account.

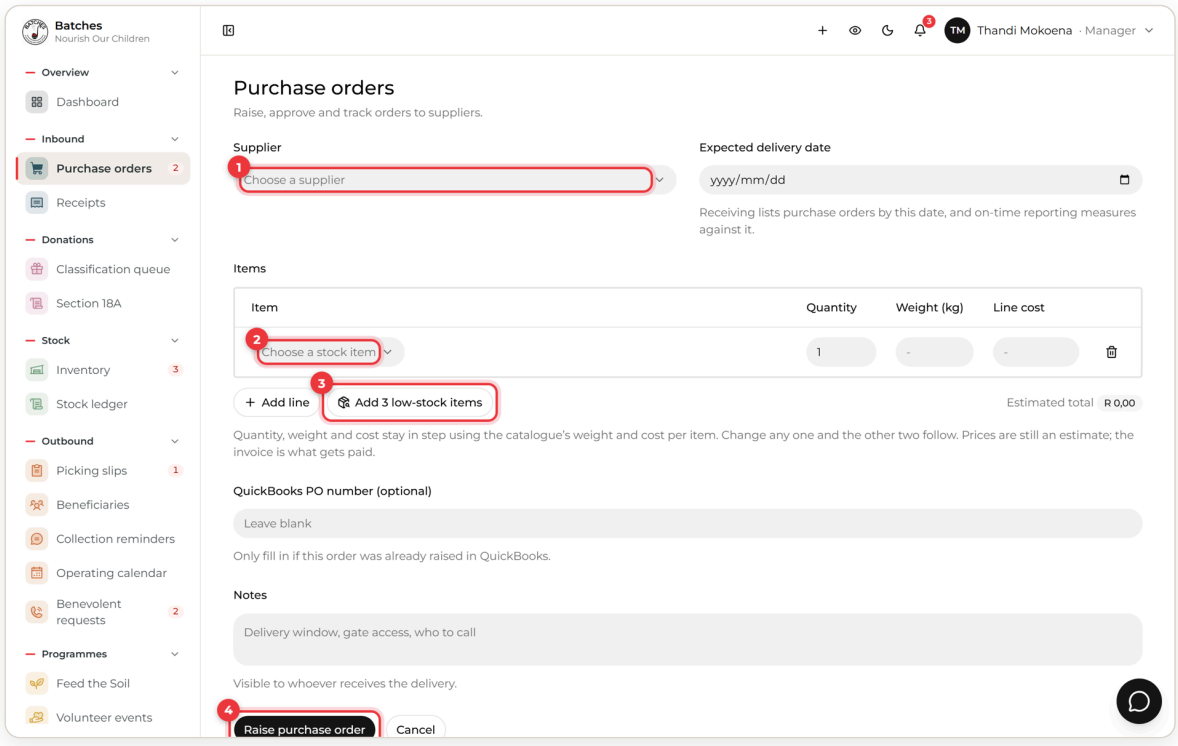
> **TIP**
>
> The **+** button in the top bar starts a picking slip, purchase order, beneficiary, benevolent request, stock adjustment or report from anywhere.

6.2 Ordering from a supplier



PURCHASE ORDERS

1. **New purchase order** starts an order.
2. The tabs sort orders by where they are: open, awaiting approval, in transit, follow-up required and so on.
3. An order *pending approval* needs a manager to open it and approve it. Approved orders are emailed to Finance and appear on the floor for receiving.



A NEW PURCHASE ORDER

1. Choose the supplier and the expected delivery date.
2. Add each item and its quantity. Weight and cost fill themselves in from the product list.

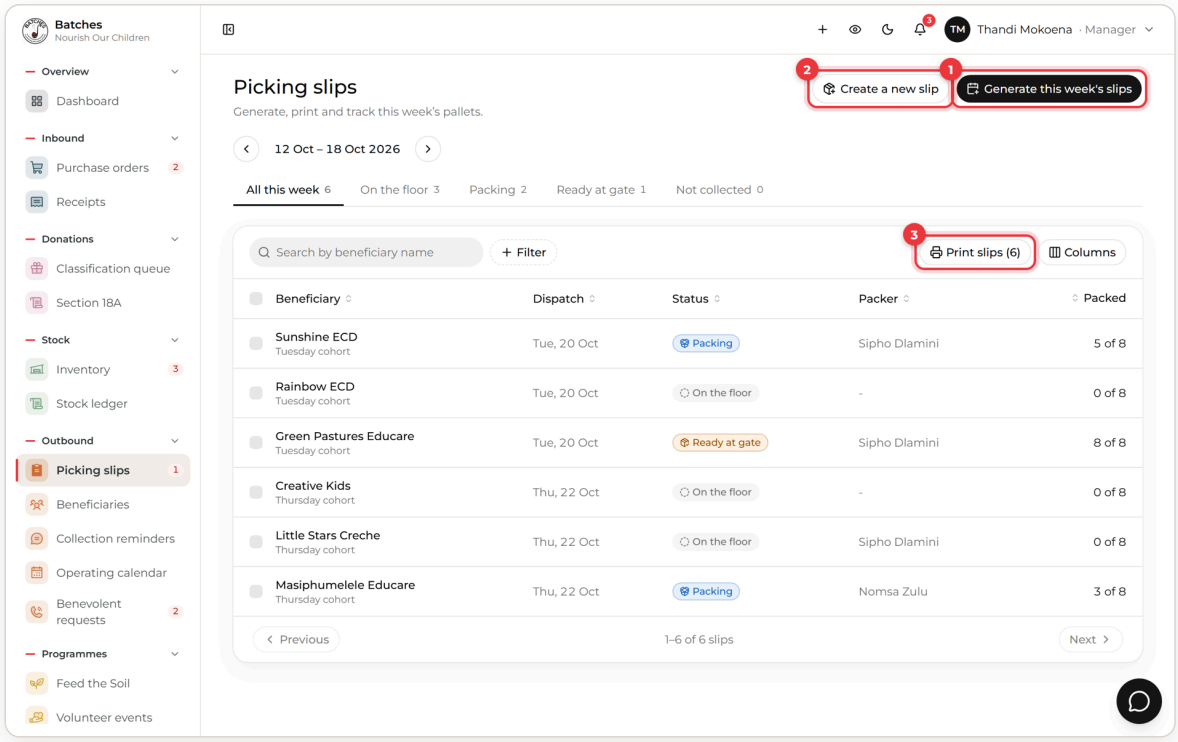
3 **Add low-stock items** adds everything at or below its reorder level in one click.

4 **Raise purchase order**. It then waits for approval.

The life of an order

Status	What it means	What you do next
Pending approval	Raised, not yet signed off	Open and **Approve**. Finance is emailed (or QuickBooks is updated)
Approved	Ready for the supplier; shows on the floor for receiving	**Mark as in transit** when the supplier confirms it is on its way
In transit	On its way	Wait for the floor to receive it. **Record follow-up** if it is late
Partially received Follow-up required	Something was short	**Create follow-up order** for the rest, **Reopen for receiving** if the supplier will bring it against this order, or **Close order** to accept it
Completed	Everything received	Nothing. The delivery note is under Receipts
Returned	Closed with a reason	Adjust stock on Inventory if goods went back; returning does not change stock

6.3 Picking slips: what each centre gets



PICKING SLIPS FOR THE WEEK

1 **Generate this week's slips** makes a slip for every centre in a cohort (Tuesday or Thursday), using the recipe in use, or each centre's standing order.

2 **Create a new slip** makes one slip by hand, for example for a soup kitchen or a late centre. Use the override for a make-up delivery on another day.

3 **Print slips** prints the selected slips with their QR codes for the floor.

- Slips can be generated ahead and packed on any day before pickup.
- Open a slip to assign a packer, edit its lines while it is still on the floor, or release a claimed pallet.
- Slips marked *not collected* need a decision: the pallet is still in the warehouse.

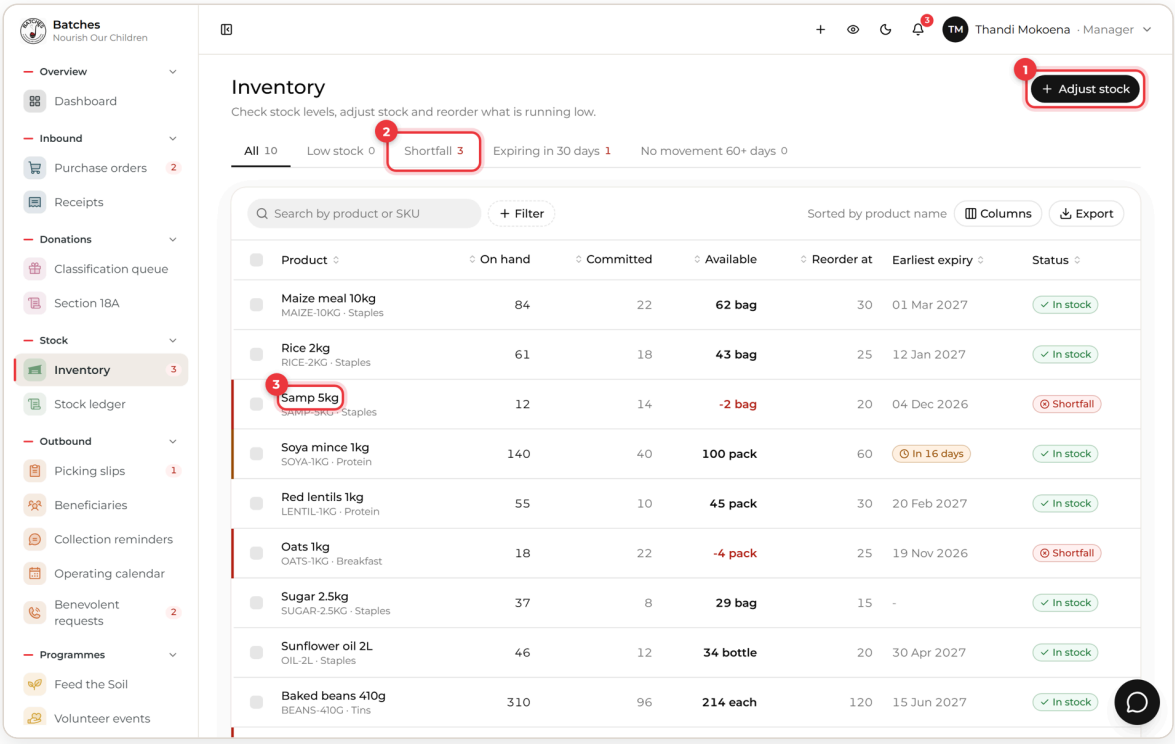
BEFORE YOU GENERATE

Check the recipe in **Settings › Recipes** and each centre's child count under **Beneficiaries**. The quantities come from them: quantity per child × the centre's child band.

6.4 Centres, reminders and the calendar

- **Beneficiaries** holds each centre: its cohort, child count, contact and whether it is active and approved. Only active, approved centres get slips.
- **Collection reminders** shows the messages sent to centres before their pickup day.
- **Operating calendar** sets each cohort's pickup day, public holidays and closures. Public holidays are known to the system already.
- **Impact map** shows each centre as a circle sized by meals enabled in a period, grey where nothing reached it, with the active centres not served listed beside it.

6.5 Stock



INVENTORY

1. **Adjust stock** corrects a count, for example after the Friday stock take. Every change is kept in the **Stock ledger** with your name and reason.
2. **Shortfall** lists products promised to slips beyond what is on the shelf. Order these first.
3. A red edge marks a product short of stock; an orange date marks stock close to expiry. Click a row to see its deliveries and history.

- A product is marked *low* when available stock falls to its reorder threshold.
- The **Stock ledger** lists every movement: received, dispatched, decanted, adjusted and wastage.
- The **Map** tab shows the warehouse floor plan. Open an area and choose **Count this area** to record what is there. Counts never change stock by themselves: where a count differs, adjust stock from the area.
- **Today**, above the map, sums up the day: collections, deliveries, packing, people on site and donations.

FEWER FULL STOCK TAKES

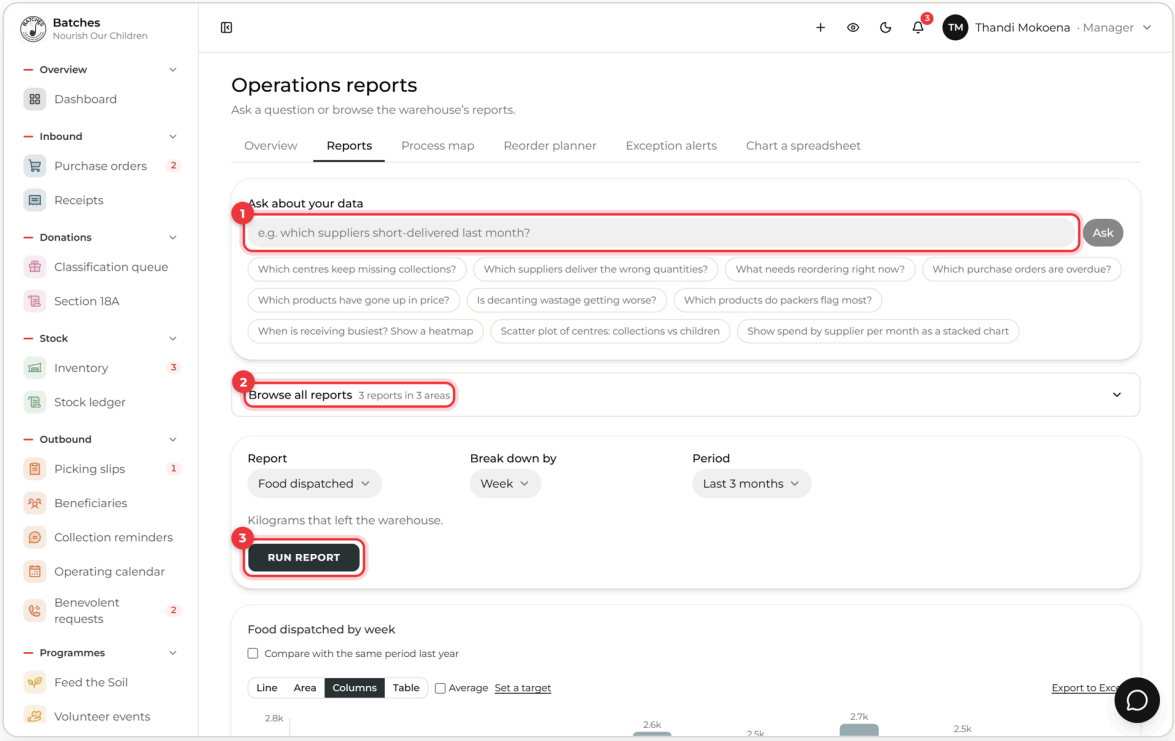
Because every movement is recorded, the Friday count can move from counting everything to counting a few areas a week on the Map, and checking the shortfall and ledger for anything unusual. Keep a full count at month end.

6.6 Programmes, requests and donations

- **Benevolent requests**: requests logged on the floor wait here. Approve by choosing items and quantities (pallets come first if stock runs short), or decline with a reason.
- **Feed the Soil** shows collection kits and compost logged, with totals.
- **Volunteer events** is where events and time slots are set up and volunteers are booked in, including walk-ins on the day.
- **Classification queue**: donated items the floor could not match. Classify each one to a product to finish the donation.
- **Section 18A**: donors who asked for a certificate, the form sent to them, and its status. Certificates are issued from here.
- **Receipts**: every delivery note and dispatch note, to view or print.

Benevolent requests, Feed the Soil and Volunteer events each work the same way: a list, tabs across the top, and a panel when you click a row.

6.7 Reports



OPERATIONS REPORTS

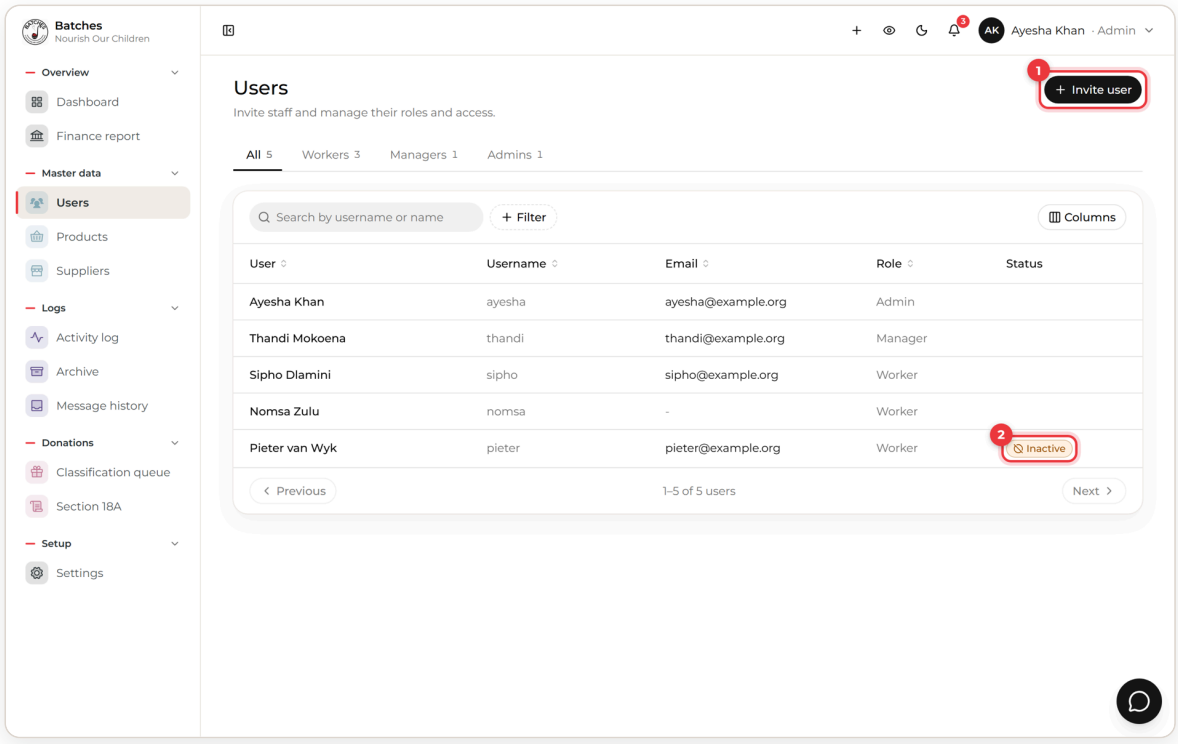
1. Ask about your data in plain words, or tap one of the example questions.
2. **Browse all reports** lists every report the system has, by area.
3. Or choose a report, how to break it down and the period, then **Run report**. Charts can be saved, exported to Excel, or emailed on a schedule.

- Operations reports chart dispatch, spend, wastage and collection over a period.
- The **Impact report** turns the same data into figures for funders and can be printed as a PDF.

07
Admins

Admins look after accounts and the set-up everything else depends on: people, products, suppliers, the warehouse layout and settings. Getting these right makes every other screen correct.

7.1 People



USERS

1. **Invite user**: type their name, email and role. They get an email with a link to choose a username and password.
2. Someone leaving? Open them and **deactivate** the account. They are signed out at once and cannot log in. It is never deleted, so their past work still shows who did it.

Edit a user to change their name, email or role; users cannot change these themselves. Give each person the least access their job needs: most of the team are warehouse staff.

7.2 Products and suppliers

Under **Master data** in the side menu.

Field	Why it matters
Name, SKU, unit	The unit is what stock is counted in (kg, can, crate…)
Weight and cost	Optional, but without them purchase orders cannot work out weight or cost, and reports cannot value stock
Reorder threshold	The level at which the product is marked low. 0 turns the warning off
Can be decanted	Only these appear on Decanting and can be part quantities

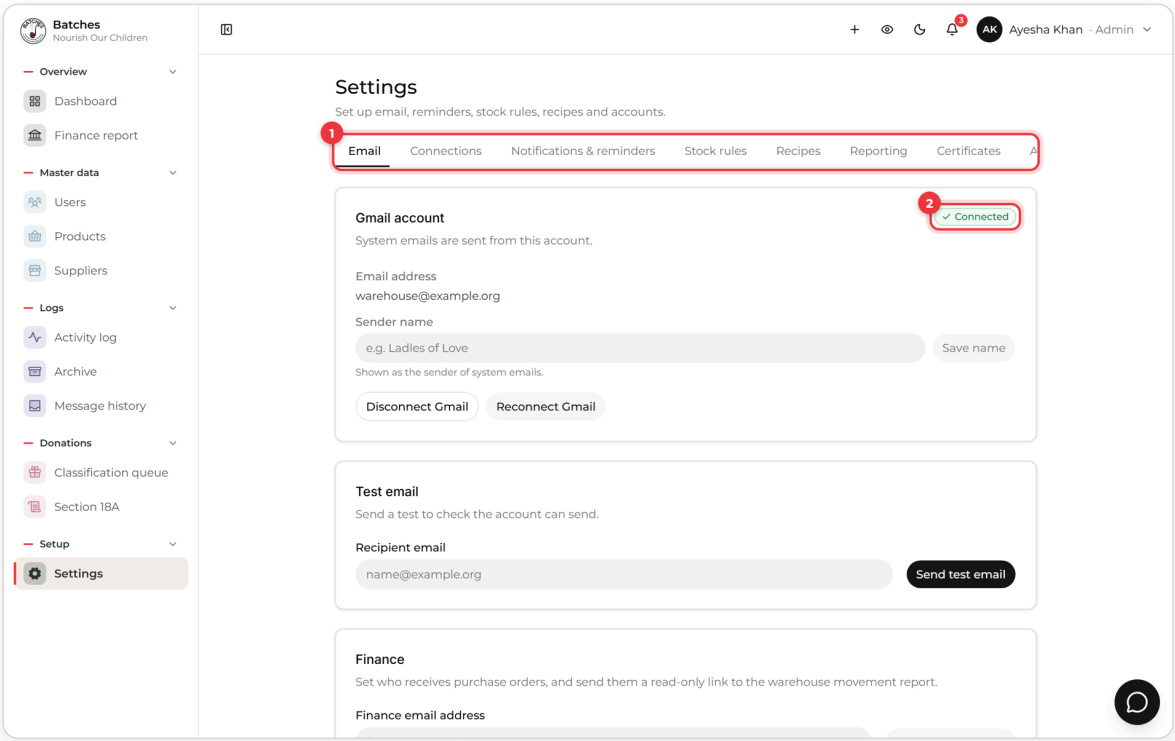
Field	Why it matters
Barcode	Add product › **Start from a barcode** looks the barcode up in the public Open Food Facts database to fill in details
Supplier's products	A purchase order can only include products its supplier is listed as supplying

Deactivate a product or supplier to stop new orders; history is kept. Delete is only for something added by mistake.

7.3 Warehouse layout

Under **Warehouse layout**, draw the building: dry stores, cold rooms, floor areas, pallet staging areas, doors and the dispatch and receiving gates. Drag each into place and drag the corner to size it. Set a capacity in kilograms (or pallet spaces for staging) and the categories each store is meant for. Areas cannot overlap. **Save layout**; managers then count stock into it on Inventory › Map.

7.4 Settings



SETTINGS

1. The tabs: **Email**, **Connections**, **Notifications & reminders**, **Stock rules**, **Recipes**, **Reporting** and **Certificates**.
2. **Connected** shows the Gmail account system emails are sent from. **Connections** shows whether email, AI, phone alerts and QuickBooks are working.

Setting	What it changes
Email	The connected Gmail account, and the Finance address purchase orders are sent to
Stock rules	What a crate, bag, box and punnet weigh, and the two expiry warnings
Notifications & reminders	When centres are reminded to collect, and the not-collected cut-off
Recipes	The menu picking slips are made from (summer and winter, each with a start date, plus date overrides), children per band, and which centres keep a standing order
Certificates	The organisation details printed on Section 18A certificates

7.5 Logs and the finance report

- **Activity log**: what staff did and when, and the door sign-in log for volunteers. Click a line to open the record.
- **Archive**: records that were removed, and the option to restore them.
- **Message history**: every email and message the system sent, and whether it was delivered. Check here first when someone says they did not get an email.
- **Finance report**: the warehouse movement report Finance works from. It can be shared by a link.

08

EVERYONE

A week in Batches

The warehouse week, with the screen for each job. Collection days follow the cohorts in Settings; Tuesday and Thursday are shown here.

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
• Receive the weekly vegetables (Receiving) • Generate Tuesday's and Thursday's slips (Picking slips) • Decant dry goods (Decanting) • Start packing Tuesday's pallets	• Dispatch cohort 1 at the gate (Dispatch) • Check flagged pallets before release • Manager: follow up late pallets	• Pack Thursday's pallets (Packing) • Wash Feed the Soil buckets; log compost • Manager: approve requests and orders	• Dispatch cohort 2 (Dispatch) • Prepare the areas to count tomorrow	• Count areas on Inventory › Map • Adjust stock with a reason where counts differ • Manager: review shortfall, raise orders

Every day

- [ ] Manager opens the dashboard's **Needs attention** and clears it
- [ ] Donations recorded as they arrive; classification queue cleared
- [ ] Volunteers given the day's gate code
- [ ] No pallet leaves without a driver's name and signature

Every month

- [ ] Full stock count and adjustments
- [ ] Impact report printed for funders and the board
- [ ] Admin deactivates anyone who has left
- [ ] Admin checks Settings › Connections and Message history

09

EVERYONE

Quick answers and words we use

The questions the team asks most, and what the words on the screens mean.

Problem	What to do
I forgot my password	Tap **Forgot password?** on the sign-in page. The link in the email works once, for one hour.
A screen says there is no signal	Carry on. Saved work waits on the phone and sends itself later. Do not enter it twice.
I cannot see a screen a colleague can	Screens depend on your role. Ask an admin if your role is wrong.
The order I need is not in Receiving	It may still be waiting for approval. Ask a manager to approve it.
A pallet will not release at the gate	The centre may be inactive, or the pallet not yet packed. Call a manager.
I made a mistake in a count	A manager can correct stock in Inventory with **Adjust stock**. The change is recorded with a reason.
A volunteer's gate code does not work	Codes change at midnight; read today's from the dashboard. Or let them scan the pallet's QR code instead.
Someone did not get an email	Admin: check Message history, then Settings › Connections to see whether Gmail is connected.
The first page takes nearly a minute	On the free hosting plan the system sleeps when idle and wakes on the first visit. See the handover document.
The app looks out of date	Name menu › **Refresh cache**, or close and reopen the page.
Something else	Use **Help** in the name menu, or ask the chat button at the bottom right.

Words we use

Word	Meaning
Cohort	A group of centres that collect on the same day (for example Tuesday or Thursday)
ECD centre / beneficiary	An early childhood development centre or other organisation that receives food
Picking slip	The list of what one centre gets on one collection day; it becomes one pallet
Recipe	The menu that sets how much of each product a centre gets per child
Standing order	A fixed list a centre gets instead of the recipe
Decanting	Splitting a bulk sack into smaller bags
Committed / available	Stock promised to pallets / stock left to promise
Flag	A note from the packer that an item is short, damaged or swapped
Purchase order (PO)	An order to a supplier, approved by a manager before it can be received
Section 18A	A South African tax certificate for donors to a public benefit organisation
Classification queue	Donated items waiting to be matched to a product

Word	Meaning
Benevolent request	A one-off request for food from someone outside the centre programme
Gate code	Today's six-digit code volunteers type to sign in
Outbox	Work saved on a phone with no signal, waiting to send

Batches was built for Ladles of Love by UCT INF3003W Team 22, 2026. Screens change as the system grows: when something here no longer matches, the in-app Help (name menu) is kept up to date with each screen.